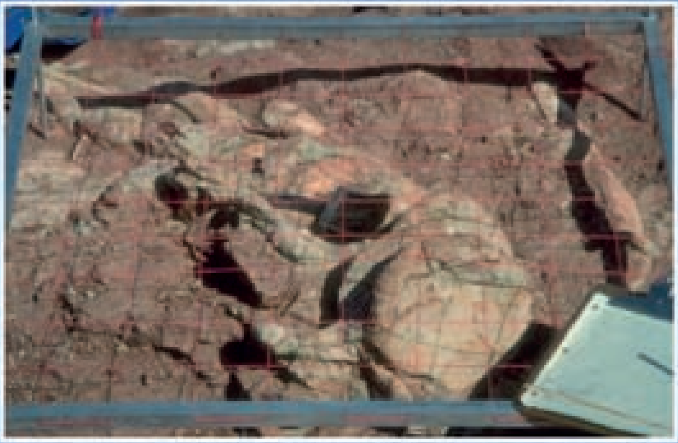
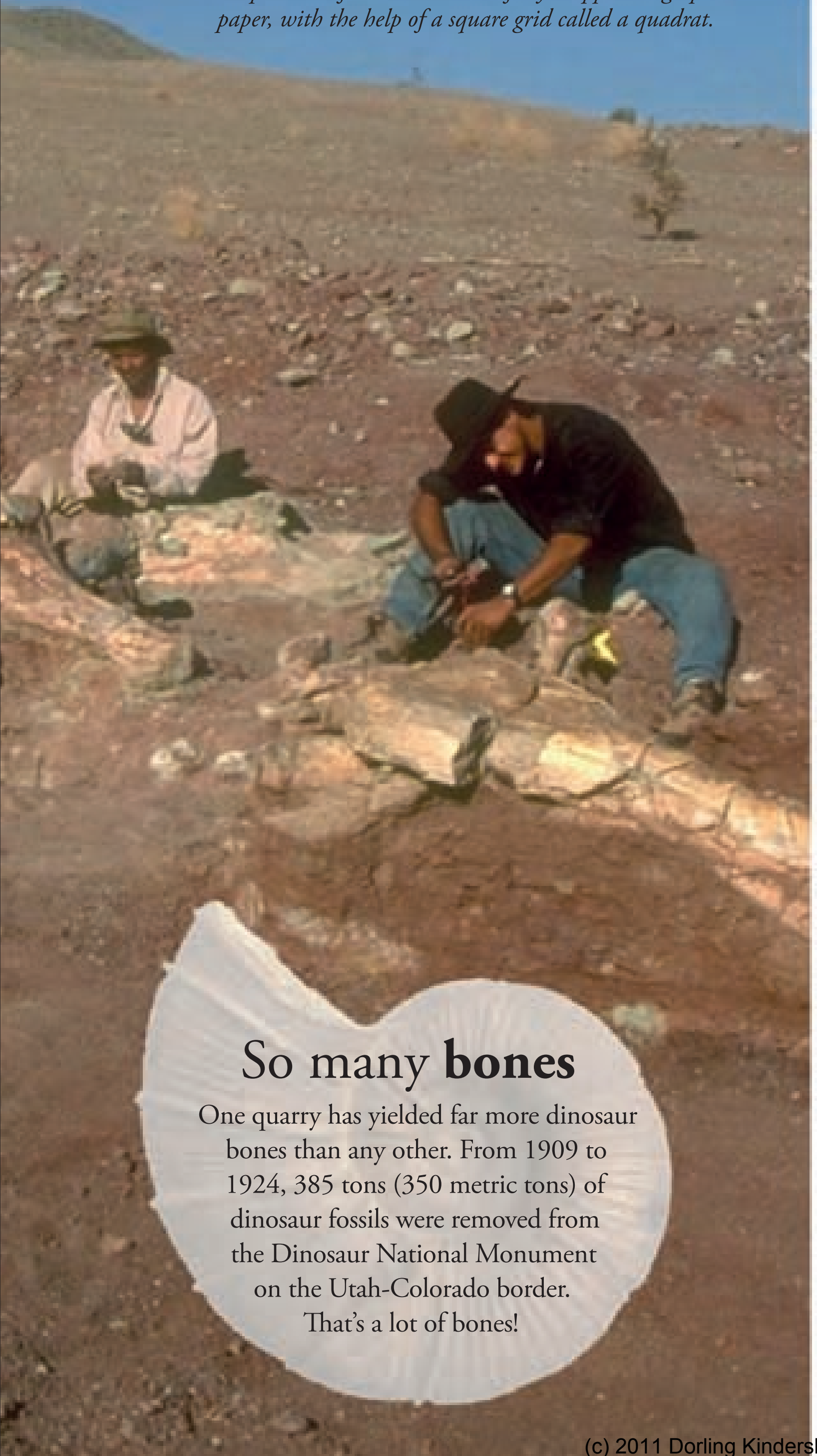
EXCAVATING A DINOSAUR

The excavation of two dinosaur fossils, *Afrovenator* (a theropod) and *Jobaria* (a sauropod) in Africa is shown here in a series of photographs. The bones were first discovered by local tribesmen, who found them jutting out of desert rock. It can take many months to excavate a complete dinosaur find, and this dig was no exception.



▲ A SLOW JOB *Once the paleontologists have carefully removed all dirt from around each of the fossilized bones, the position of each bone is carefully mapped on graph paper, with the help of a square grid called a quadrat.*



◀ MAKING A START *Painstaking work over a number of weeks to remove rock finally revealed each fossil. A large team of people worked on this dig.*

◀ ON SHOW *As more soil is removed, the fossils become clear. The team was dealing with a theropod that could reach 30 ft (9 m) and a sauropod that could reach 60 ft (18 m) in length, so the bones were large.*

◀ SITE MAP *One paleontologist made a final, detailed drawing of the bones in position. This showed clearly how some bones had separated from the animal over the millions of years it had lain encased in rock.*

◀ WRAP IT UP! *Once the bones were ready to be removed, they were covered with bandages soaked in a plaster solution. When the plaster sets hard, this protects the fossil, ready for its removal to a museum laboratory for further study.*

So many **bones**

One quarry has yielded far more dinosaur bones than any other. From 1909 to 1924, 385 tons (350 metric tons) of dinosaur fossils were removed from the Dinosaur National Monument on the Utah-Colorado border. That's a lot of bones!